OPTIONAL HELP

The keeper’s marginalia

Read one hint at a time; pause before the next.

The letter

1. Focus on the five printed lines, rather than the signature or the pencil remark.

2. Elsie mentions a beginning. What stands at the beginning of each of those five lines?

3. Take their first letters from top to bottom. Together they spell one of the four compass directions.

The shelf

1. Treat each “immediately” clue as a two-book block that cannot be split.

2. The Glass Orchard / Quiet Garden block must come before the Hidden River / Weather Atlas block.

3. The Dusk Letters must be before The Glass Orchard. Put it before both two-book blocks, then identify position three.

OPTIONAL HELP

The keeper’s marginalia

Read one hint at a time; pause before the next.

The catalogue

1. Start with the inscription belonging to the middle book, rather than decoding every card.

2. The alphabet is mirrored: A pairs with Z, B with Y, C with X, and so on.

3. The first two letters of XOLXP decode to C and L. Keep applying the same rule to the remaining letters.

The work log

1. The combination uses the finishing time. All four durations must be included.

2. The tasks take 80 minutes altogether. Add that to 09:45.

3. Add one hour first, then another twenty minutes. Write the resulting time with two hour digits and two minute digits, without a colon.